

HACKAPERTUS 2026 · TRACK 2A · FHGR

AI-Powered Job Interview Coach

The challenge and the datasets we provide

Norman Süsstrunk · FHGR · Info session, October 2026

THE PROBLEM

Young people rarely get to practise a job interview before the one that counts.

First interview at 14–16

Most apply for an apprenticeship straight out of lower secondary school, often in their very first formal interview.

Practice doesn't scale

Teachers cannot run repeated one-to-one mock interviews with individual feedback for every student.

Profolio's next step

FHGR's career-orientation platform adds AI-supported, personalised interview training in a safe space.

WHAT YOU BUILD

An Apertus-based coach that runs realistic interviews and gives constructive feedback.



Adaptive interview

Asks, listens, follows up on vague answers, adapts to the candidate and the job.



Useful feedback

Criteria-based, age-appropriate, with a concrete next step for each teenager.



Multilingual

German, French and Italian. Swiss German dialects are a plus.

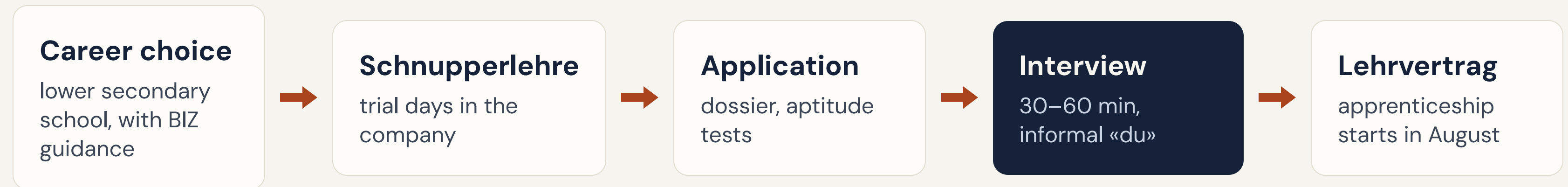


Voice-ready

Designed so real-time text-to-speech can be added later.

SWISS CONTEXT

The interview is one step on the road into an apprenticeship



EBA · 2 years

Federal VET Certificate, more practical profile (FR: AFP, IT: CFP)

EFZ · 3–4 years

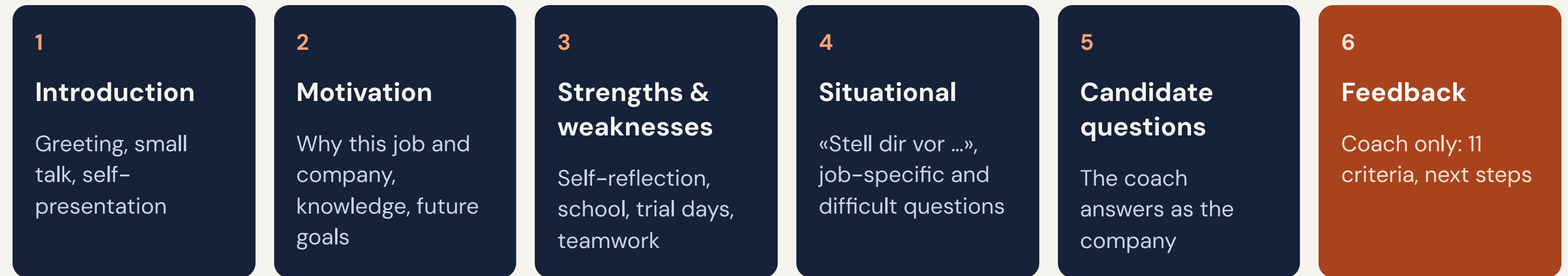
Federal VET Diploma, dual: company, vocational school, industry courses (FR: CFC, IT: AFC)

BM1 / BM2

Vocational Baccalaureate during (BM1) or after (BM2) the EFZ; opens universities of applied sciences

INTERVIEW FLOW

Six stages, mapped to FHGR's ten interview phases



A typical real interview lasts 30–60 minutes. A practice session usually covers 10–15 main questions plus follow-ups.

RULES & JUDGING

Run locally, stay efficient, then be judged on quality

Required

Apertus 1.5 · 8B as the model

< 32 GB VRAM, consumer hardware, on-premise

< 5 LLM calls per candidate answer, on average

Docker container, source code, docs, visual overview

Scoring

50 % Performance — LLM-as-judge benchmark



25 % Consistency — across scenarios, profiles, languages



25 % Innovation — methods and architectures



THE DATASETS

FHGR didactic material, extended with carefully specified synthetic data

242

questions in DE · FR · IT, plus
296 dialect versions

706

candidate answers at 4 levels,
each annotated

11 × 4

rubric: criteria × levels, plus
27 feedback rules

30

pairs of good vs poor AI
feedback

24

synthetic candidate profiles

30

apprenticeship postings,
linked to real occupations

28

interview scenarios with
judge criteria

15

full interviews with reference
feedback

HOW IT FITS TOGETHER

Three linked groups, connected by stable ids

PERSONALISATION

Postings P-xx · **Candidates** C-xx



Scenarios S-xx



Transcripts T-xx, with reference feedback

ASSESSMENT

Questions Q-...



Answers A-..., by question and occupation



Annotations, one per answer

STANDARDS

Rubric: 11 criteria × 4 levels

Feedback rules T1 ... A1

Feedback examples F-xx

Annotations, transcripts and feedback examples all cite these rules and criteria.

QUESTIONS

242 interview questions, common and job-specific

Category	Ids	Origin	n	Every question has
General, 10 interview phases	Q-01...10	FHGR	81	German master text, French and Italian (Swiss usage) Target criteria, flow stage, difficulty Conditions, e.g. «only if Stellwerk was taken» Dialect versions: zh, be (+ bs, gr, vs)
Job-specific, 22 Berufsfelder	Q-BF...	FHGR	125	
Situational «Stell dir vor ...»	Q-SIT	synthetic	12	
Difficult / unexpected	Q-DIF	synthetic	10	
Phone call, online, assessment ...	Q-OTH	synthetic	14	

CANDIDATE ANSWERS

Same question, different levels

«Warum hast du dich für diesen Beruf entschieden?»

LEVEL 2 · AUSBAUFÄHIG

«Meine Mutter arbeitet auch im Spital, und sie hat gesagt, das wäre gut für mich. Und ich helfe gern Leuten.»

LEVEL 4 · SEHR GUT

«Ich fahre seit vier Jahren Kart, und mit meinem Onkel schraube ich oft am Motor. Einmal hat der Motor gestottert, und wir haben zusammen den Vergaser gereinigt ... In der Schnupperlehre habe ich gesehen, dass heute viel mit Diagnosegeräten und Elektronik gemacht wird.»

Classes: strong 322 · weak 276 · incomplete 61 · problematic 47 **96** verbatim from FHGR

EXPERT ANNOTATIONS

Every answer comes with an annotation

CRITERIA SCORES

motivation 2 · relevance 3 · goal orientation 2

WEAKNESSES

Wirkt von aussen bestimmt: «sie hat gesagt»

COACH ACTION

probe → «Wann hast du selbst gemerkt, dass dir das Helfen liegt?»

COACH FEEDBACK

«Du hast gesagt, dass du gern Leuten hilfst. Das passt sehr gut zum Beruf Fachfrau Gesundheit. Im Moment klingt es aber noch so, als hätte vor allem deine Mutter entschieden. Erzähl lieber, wo du selbst gemerkt hast, dass dir das liegt, zum Beispiel beim Schnuppern.»

Rules applied: R1 · K1 · R2 · K2 · A1

Also: strengths, missing elements, expert comment, improved answer, problem flags.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

The FHGR rubric: 11 criteria, 4 levels

Clarity	Relevance	Motivation	Self-awareness
Communication	Concrete examples	Demeanour	Preparation
Goal orientation	Difficult questions	Initiative	

Blue = the six core criteria named in the challenge Levels: 1 Ungenügend · 2 Ausbaufähig · 3 Gut · 4 Sehr gut

Feedback should coach, not grade

R1 Strengths first

K1 Quote the conversation

R2 One or two points

R3 A concrete next step

B3 No character labels

E2 «not yet», not «not»

L2 Never create fear

L3 Distress → a real person

POOR · breaks B3, L2

«Du bist wenig reflektiert. So findest du keine Lehrstelle.»

GOOD

«Du trittst selbstsicher auf. Eine konkrete Stärke hast du noch nicht genannt. Wähl eine aus und erzähl, wo man sie gesehen hat.»

24 candidates meet 30 apprenticeship postings

Postings

Fictional companies, real occupations from [berufsberatung.ch](#)

22 DE · 5 FR · 3 IT, all 22 occupational fields

Interviewer persona and insider facts, so the coach can answer questions and judge preparation

Candidates include sensitive cases

Case	Coach must
Dyslexia	not judge spelling
German at B1 level	not judge language
Gender-atypical choice	avoid stereotypes
Broken-off apprenticeship	coach a fair story
Strong self-doubt	support, refer

From scenario to full interview to feedback

28

Scenarios

Interview, online, phone call, assessment. Planned questions, adaptive hooks, checkable judge criteria.

«Der Coach bewertet das Deutschniveau nicht.»

15

Full interviews

444 turns in DE, FR, IT and three dialects, including the FHGR Konstrukteur example. Each has gold reference feedback on all 11 criteria.

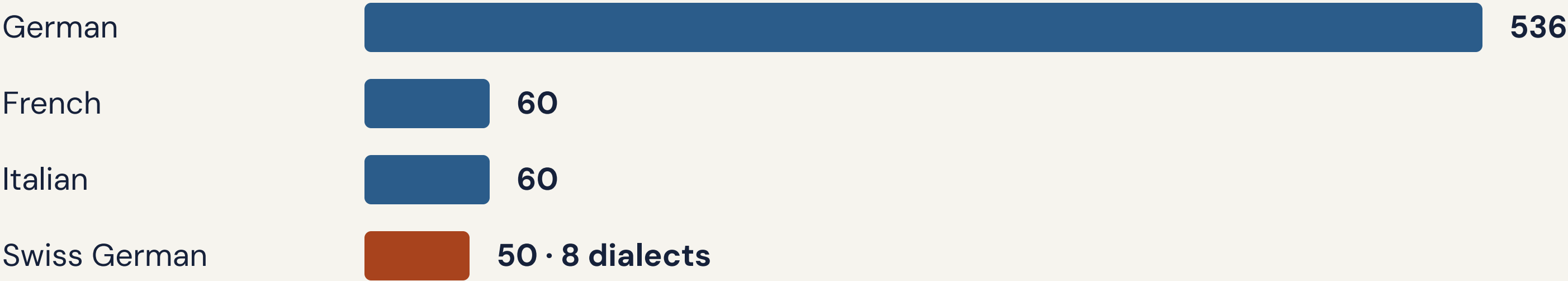
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Good vs poor feedback

13 typical LLM failures: harsh, overpraise, invented evidence, wrong language, ignoring distress ... Includes spoken (TTS) feedback.

LANGUAGES

Answers by language



All 242 questions in DE, FR, IT. French and Italian answers cover the same 14 anchor questions, for cross-language consistency.

Dialect is never penalised in Swiss interviews. Only tone and politeness count.

USING THE DATA

Ideas for your coach

Goal	Start with
Plan the interview	questions, scenario question plans, posting facts
Ask good follow-ups	follow_up_question, coach_action, adaptive hooks
Assess answers	answers + criteria_scores as few-shot or test set
Write feedback	coach_feedback, reference feedback, good examples
Guardrails	problematic answers: distress, manipulation ...
Test yourself	simulation personas + scenario success criteria

All files are JSON Lines: `pandas.read_json(path, lines=True)`. Start with datasets/README.md.

PLEASE KEEP IN MIND

Development data, not the benchmark

Synthetic, unreviewed

Generated against a fixed spec and checked automatically, not yet by experts.

Dialects need care

Spelling isn't standardised; LLM-written dialect can be off.

Don't overfit

The judge metrics and prompts are separate. Generalise, don't copy wording.

Fictional companies

Persons and companies are invented; occupation data is real.